FOREST TYPES IN TAMIL NADU
Champion and Seth (1968)

I. Moist tropical Forests
1. Tropical wet evergreen forests
2. Tropical semi evergreen forests
3. Tropical moist deciduous forests
4. Littoral and swamp forests

II. Dry tropical Forests
5. Tropical dry deciduous forests
6. Tropical thorn forests
7. Tropical dry evergreen forests

III. Montane Sub-Tropical Forests
8. Sub-tropical broad leaved hill forests

IV. Montane Temperate Forests

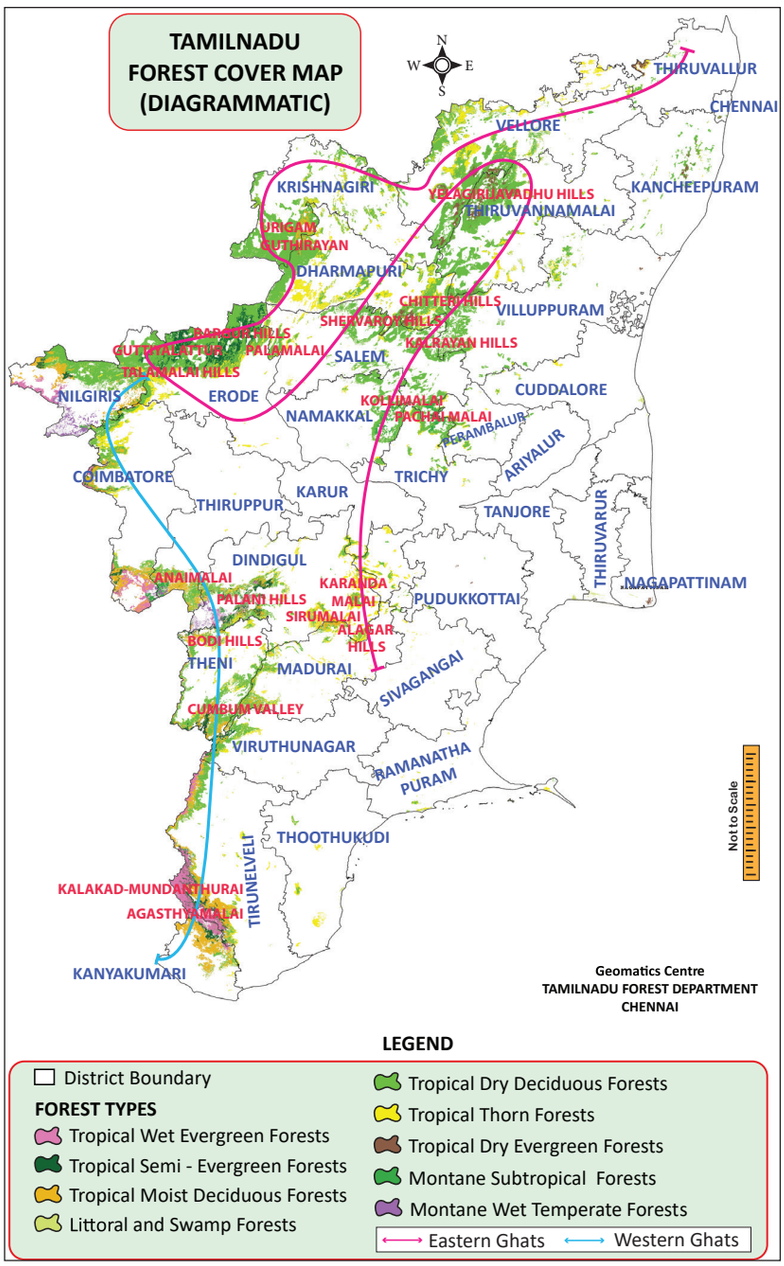


Figure 7.23: Map showing forest types of Tamil Nadu.

Bauhinia and *Zizyphus.* Some common Climbers are *Combretum, Hiptage*: herbs like *Abutilon, Achyranthes* and *Tribulus.*These are found in Andhra Pradesh, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Orissa, Madhya Pradesh and also found in all districts of Tamil Nadu at lower elevations.

6. Tropical thorn forests

These forests extend from plains upto 400 M . Occur in the areas where annual rainfall is between 20 and 70 cm. The dry season is hot and very long. The vegetation is of open type consisting of small trees (8 to 10 m length) and thorny or spiny shrubs with a stunted growth. The plants remain leafless for most of the year and many species have latex.. In rainy season, there is a luxuriant growth of ephemeral herbs and grass. The most common plant species are *Acacia, Cassia, Calotropis, Albizzia, Zizyphus, Dichrostachys, Euphorbia, Capparis,* and including unpalatable species. They are found in Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Maharashtra, South

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